

MICHAEL GRANT

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Product marketing leader with 25 years scaling revenue for enterprise technology. Specializes in buyer psychology, GTM integration, and AI/cloud solutions. Built practices that turned complex platform transitions into measurable pipeline, from \$500K to \$500M ARR, 167% YoY cloud growth, and 24% asset download rates at 4–5x industry benchmark.

Buyer Enablement & Psychology	GTM Integration (M&A)	Platform Narrative & Positioning
AI/ML Cloud Solutions Marketing	Sales Enablement at Scale	Analyst Relations
Vertical GTM Strategy	Content Architecture & Measurement	PMM Team Leadership (up to 24)

EXPERIENCE

Liaison Creative + Marketing Austin, TX

Feb 2024 – Present

Director, Buyer Impact Analysis Practice

Pivoted from tech intentionally to commercialize research on Buyer Enablement. Pitched an AI-driven diagnostic practice to agency leadership as a business development tool and cornerstone of a new division after identifying that client delays originated from internal restructuring rather than lack of interest.

- Secured **100% internal funding** by running a live **Buyer Impact Analysis (BIA)** on the agency owner’s documented technology purchase frustrations.
- Built a 60-point AI-enabled scoring tool that replaced manual roadmaps, delivering **33 BIA engagements in 90 days** and converting **3 Fortune 500** strategic engagements. Evolved the tool from a set of prompts to a **Claude Cowork SKILL.md**, shaving days off the analysis.
- Won strategic engagements at **Dell SMB** (reviving a 5+ year dormant account) and several other F500 companies. **Salesforce Regional VP** validated the offering, saying “There is nothing this advanced in the market at this price.”

NetApp San Jose, CA

Oct 2022 – Dec 2023

Principal Product Marketer – AI GTM

Diagnosed why sellers avoided AI conversations: value translation failure, not an awareness gap. Rebuilt GTM around technical and non-technical buyers with Outcome-First messaging, operational alignment, and targeted seller enablement.

- Increased quarterly pipeline from 75 to 97 deals (**30% lift**). Expanded active seller participation from 283 to 600 (**112% growth**). Maintained revenue and margin despite higher deal volume.
- Validated narrative through two MVP playbook iterations with select SMEs and sales teams before global rollout, reducing adoption risk and accelerating usage during release.
- Enforced Level 3 Operational Alignment, unified sales and marketing on shared data systems and qualification rules, before scaling.
- Built AI Frameworks** to offload first-draft writing, competitive research, and market analysis, gaining nearly 8 hours of additional focus time each week.

NetApp San Jose, CA

Apr 2022 – Sep 2022

Solution Marketing Strategist – CloudOps

The company wanted to penetrate “born in cloud” and “journey to the cloud” organizations. Assembled a two-man team to develop the program. After reviewing the sales team’s input, carefully assessed the opportunity before layering on another sales play.

- Assessed the total CloudOps market to be a \$27B opportunity by partnering with IDC to interview 50+ architects and operators.
- Learned that 82% data management teams and 77% cloud architects shared CloudOps budgets with on-prem storage teams, making independent sales inefficient.
- Recommended consolidation with the hybrid cloud program instead—preventing misaligned investment.
- Built the full launch plan, playbook, and assets in 45 days to preserve optionality. The executive team agreed with the recommendation and canceled the program.

NetApp San Jose, CA

May 2020 – Mar 2022

Corporate Marketing Strategist – Brand to Revenue Conversion

CMO-sponsored squad leader (4-person cross-functional team) integrating brand, product, and sales strategy to drive NetApp cloud adoption across AWS, Azure, and Google. Applied Reputation-to-Revenue framework (Awareness

→ Consideration → Intent), launched "The Specialists" identity with ungated educational content, deployed Buying Jobs-to-be-Done company-wide, and expanded reach into esports, podcasts, and NYT partnership.

- Generated 86% new-to-brand site visitors and drove 65% YoY traffic growth in Q1. Ungated content hit 24% download rate—four to five times industry benchmark.
- Influenced \$1.1B in pipeline (29% of all won deals, 35% of cloud ARR) by surfacing unconsidered needs through Cloud Overspend Analyzer and educational tools.
- Solved perception gap: repositioned legacy on-prem vendor as cloud specialist, shifting entry point from on-premises solutions to cloud-led engagements.

NetApp San Jose, CA

Apr 2017 – May 2020

Senior Product Marketing Strategist – Data Fabric and Cloud

Architected a Buyer Enablement program to enable NetApp's repositioning from on-premises storage vendor to cloud data management company. Field sellers lacked messaging, tools, and training for a portfolio they'd never sold. Built integrated enablement across four vectors:

- Developed Data Fabric and Hybrid Cloud messaging framework, adopted across Americas field, partner channels, and corporate campaigns.
- Worked with SMEs and a 6-person marketing team to develop the Virtual Playbook, NetApp's cloud sales playbook, refined through multiple iterations incorporating field input and competitive positioning.
- Delivered cloud sales training via 20-city partner academy roadshow, web modules, and full-day Sales Kickoff sessions.
- Launched partner enablement programs extending cloud GTM beyond direct sales as NetApp scaled its partner-led business. Results: 145% growth in net new cloud customers.
- Helped develop and executed NetApp-Hyperscaler joint GTM as the company rolled out new capabilities for both organizations to sell.
- Directly influenced cloud revenue, which posted triple-digit year-over-year ARR, helping the company earn partnership awards from Google, AWS, and Azure.

Dell Technologies Round Rock, TX

Nov 2012 – Nov 2016

Sr. Director, Software Product Marketing

- Led GTM for Dell's Data Protection portfolio with a team of 6 senior PMMs and 18 campaign staff supporting 8 product owners with assets, campaigns, analyst relations, and field enablement. Grew data protection 2.5X in revenue and 5X in customers; achieved Top 4 Gartner Magic Quadrant rating within 36 months.
- Directed global field enablement across 8 concurrent product launches, building executive narratives, integrated launch frameworks, and sales playbooks that continuously supplied qualified leads to sales.

Dell Technologies Round Rock, TX

Jan 2008 – Nov 2012

Sr. Director, Enterprise Storage Marketing

- Led GTM integration for **four acquisitions** (EqualLogic, Compellent, AppAssure, Quest), managing 100+ products in market concurrently while sustaining existing revenue motions across a \$3B+ division.
- Grew the PMM team from 6 to 23 to sustain integration velocity, launching an average of **42 products per year** while shifting the sales mix to 90% Dell-owned IP, **enhancing division margins 3X**.

Dell Technologies Round Rock, TX

Jan 2003 – Jan 2008

Product Marketing Manager, Dell/EMC Storage Portfolio

- Built 7 fully-functional AX100 demo arrays in portable suitcases to train **4,000+ salespeople** worldwide — enabling sellers to demonstrate solution simplicity firsthand and contributing to a **tripling of division revenue** and **nearly \$1B** in annual sales.

ADDITIONAL

Certifications: Pragmatic Institute Certified Product Marketer | HubSpot Content Marketing | Various AI certifications

Technical Skills: Adobe Analytics | Tableau | PowerBI | HubSpot | Asana | Jira | Adobe Photoshop

Proprietary Frameworks: AI-driven GTM | Buying Jobs To Be Done | Outcome-First Messaging | Opportunity Matrix | Competitive Analysis

Currently Building with AI: "Open Mind" a database-backed, MCP-connected knowledge system [components Supabase, OpenRouter, Win11 terminal]. **Expected outcome:** same user experience regardless of model with knowledge and context that compounds week over week.

EDUCATION

Texas A&M University Agriculture Sciences and Economics

College Station, TX